Leaders of the World's Major Religions

A sourced reference guide to the current principal living leaders of the world's major religious traditions — offices and facts only. Compiled 17 September 2026.

Metric	Count
Religions/traditions covered	14
Religious leaders listed	83
— Christianity	33
— Islam	16
— Hinduism	7
— Buddhism	9
— Sikhism	1
— Jainism	2
— Shinto	1
— Taoism	1
— Judaism	4
— Zoroastrianism	2
— Yazidism	2
— Druze	3
— Tenrikyo	1
— Bahá'í	1
Rows with official website	48
Rows with documented spouse	13
Rows with published office phone	11

Method

Four parallel research workers compiled this guide from official sources first — the Vatican, ecumenical patriarchate and autocephalous church sites, al-Azhar, the Diyanet, the Imamat, the Dalai Lama's office, the SGPC, the Bahá■í World Centre, chief rabbinates, and communion world-body sites — cross-checking every leader against at least two sources. Currency is September 2026. Only officially published contact information is included; no personal or private phone numbers or email addresses appear anywhere. Unverifiable fields were left blank rather than guessed.

Key caveats

• The guide covers every tradition with roughly 15M+ adherents plus globally significant smaller organized faiths; the README documents the inclusion rule and adherent estimates.
• Traditions with no single leader (Hinduism, Buddhism, Judaism, Zoroastrianism, Druze) list the most prominent offices instead — see the README.
• Contact details are sparse by design: monastic and primatial offices rarely publish phones or emails.
• Disputed successions (Karmapa, Jyotirmath, Bohra, Iran's religious office, OCU canonical status, Syrian Druze leadership) are presented factually with the dispute stated; no position is taken.
• Spouse names appear only where publicly documented; celibate offices are marked in notes.

Christianity

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Catholic Church	Leo XIV	Pope	Your Holiness					Website	Source	celibate office. Elected 8 May 2025 as successor of Pope Francis; born Robert Francis Prevost.
Anglican Communion	Sarah Mullally	Archbishop of Canterbury	Your Grace	Eamonn Mullally				Website	Source	Legally became archbishop 28 January 2026; installed 25 March 2026. First woman to hold the office in its 1,400-year history.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Bartholomew I	Ecumenical Patriarch	Your All-Holiness					Website	Source	celibate office.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Theodoros II	Pope and Patriarch of Alexandria and All Africa	Your Beatitude						Source	celibate office.
Eastern Orthodox Church	John X	Greek Orthodox Patriarch of Antioch and All the East	Your Beatitude					Website	Source	celibate office.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Theophilos III	Patriarch of Jerusalem	Your Beatitude					Website	Source	celibate office.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Kirill	Patriarch of Moscow and All Rus'	Your Holiness					Website	Source	celibate office.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Porfirije	Serbian Patriarch	Your Holiness						Source	celibate office.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Daniel	Patriarch of the Romanian Orthodox Church						Website	Source	celibate office.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Daniil	Patriarch of the Bulgarian Orthodox Church and Metropolitan of Sofia							Source	celibate office.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Shio III	Catholicos-Patriarch of All Georgia	Your Holiness						Source	celibate office. Elected 11 May 2026 and enthroned 12 May 2026 after the death of Ilia II on 17 March 2026.
Eastern Orthodox Church	George	Archbishop of Nova Justiniana and All Cyprus	Your Beatitude					Website	Source	celibate office. Greek form Georgios; listed as George III.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Ieronymos II	Archbishop of Athens and All Greece	Your Beatitude		14, Ioannoy Gennadioy, 115 21 Athens, Greece				Source	celibate office.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Sawa	Archbishop of Warsaw and Metropolitan of All Poland			Al. Solidarno■ci 52,, 03-402 Warszawa, Poland	48-22-619-08-86			Source	celibate office.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Rastislav	Archbishop of Prešov, Metropolitan of the Czech Lands and Slovakia	Your Beatitude						Source	celibate office. Also transliterated Rostislav.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Joani	Archbishop of Tirana, Durrës and All Albania	Your Beatitude						Source	celibate office. Elected 16 March 2025 and installed 29 March 2025, succeeding Anastasios (d. 25 January 2025). Also styled Joan or John in English sources.
Eastern Orthodox Church	Epiphanius	Metropolitan of Kyiv and All Ukraine							Source	celibate office. Primate of the Orthodox Church of Ukraine. Its 2019 autocephaly was granted by the Ecumenical Patriarchate and is recognized by some Orthodox churches but not by the Russian Orthodox Church and others; primacy and canonical status remain disputed.
Oriental Orthodox Church	Karekin II	Catholicos of All Armenians	Your Holiness					Website	Source	celibate office. In 2026 the Armenian government pursued criminal proceedings against him and sought his removal; the church's Supreme Spiritual Council rejects state interference. He remains in office.
Oriental Orthodox Church	Aram I	Catholicos of the Holy See of Cilicia	Your Holiness					Website	Source	celibate office.
Oriental Orthodox Church	Tawadros II	Pope of Alexandria and Patriarch of the See of St. Mark	Your Holiness					Website	Source	celibate office.
Oriental Orthodox Church	Abune Mathias I	Patriarch and Catholicos of Ethiopia	Your Holiness						Source	celibate office.
Oriental Orthodox Church	Abune Basilios	Patriarch of the Eritrean Orthodox Tewahedo Church							Source	celibate office. Elected December 2024 and enthroned 26 January 2025, succeeding Qerlos. English spelling also appears as Basliyos.
Oriental Orthodox Church	Mor Ignatius Aphrem II	Patriarch of Antioch and All the East and Supreme Head of the Universal Syriac Orthodox Church	Your Holiness						Source	celibate office.
Oriental Orthodox Church	Baselios Marthoma Mathews III	Catholicos of the East and Malankara Metropolitan	Your Holiness			0481-2578499, 0481-2578500	catholicos@mosc.in		Source	celibate office.
Lutheran World Federation	Henrik Stubkjær	President of the Lutheran World Federation	Bishop	Karen Neergaard Stubkjær	Chemin du Pavillon 2, 1218, Le Grand Saconnex, Geneva	+41/22-791 61 11	lwf.info@lutheranworld.org	Website	Source	Elected September 2023 as the 14th LWF president; bishop of the Viborg Diocese, Evangelical Lutheran Church in Denmark.
Lutheran World Federation	Anne Burghardt	General Secretary of the Lutheran World Federation			Chemin du Pavillon 2, 1218, Le Grand Saconnex, Geneva	+41/22-791 61 11	lwf.info@lutheranworld.org	Website	Source	In office since 1 November 2021; first woman and first Central Eastern European to serve as LWF General Secretary.
World Methodist Council	Debra Wallace-Padgett	President of the World Methodist Council	Bishop	Lee Padgett				Website	Source	Elected 14 August 2024 for a five-year term; United Methodist bishop.
World Communion of Reformed Churches	Karen Georgia Thompson	President of the World Communion of Reformed Churches						Website	Source	Elected 22 October 2025 as WCRC president; since 2023 also General Minister and President of the United Church of Christ.
Seventh-day Adventist Church	Erton C. Köhler	President of the General Conference of Seventh-day Adventists		Adriene					Source	Elected 4 July 2025 as the 21st GC president, the first South American to lead the world church; previously GC executive secretary (2021-2025).
The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints	Dallin H. Oaks	President of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints	President	Kristen M. Oaks					Source	Announced 14 October 2025 as the 18th president after the death of Russell M. Nelson on 27 September 2025.
Mennonite World Conference	Henk Stenvers	President of the Mennonite World Conference						Website	Source	President for the 2022-2028 term, elected at Assembly 17 in Indonesia (July 2022).
Union of Utrecht (Old Catholic)	Bernd Wallet	Old Catholic Archbishop of Utrecht						Website	Source	Elected 15 February 2020 and consecrated 18 September 2021 as the 84th Old Catholic Archbishop of Utrecht; ex officio president of the Union of Utrecht's International Old Catholic Bishops' Conference. Married with four children; spouse name not published.

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Jehovah's Witnesses	Governing Body of Jehovah's Witnesses	Collective leadership body						Website	Source	Collective leadership by an 11-member Governing Body. Jody Jedele and Jacob Rumph were added on 5 October 2024. Members as of September 2026: Kenneth Cook Jr., Gage Fleegle, Samuel Herd, Geoffrey Jackson, Jody Jedele, Stephen Lett, Gerrit Lösch, Jacob Rumph, Mark Sanderson, David Splane, Jeffrey Winder.

Islam

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Sunni (Hanafi tradition)	Ahmed el-Tayeb	Grand Imam of al-Azhar	His Eminence		Al-Azhar Sheikhdom, Salah Salem Rd, El Darassa, Cairo, Egypt	19493 (hotline); +20 2 25972800		Website	Source	In office since 10 March 2010; current as of September 2026 (official biography, office since 2010-present; phone call with Coptic Pope, 10 Feb 2026; delegation meetings, May 2026).
Sunni	Nazir Mohamed Ayyad	Grand Mufti of Egypt	His Eminence		Hadiqat al-Khalideen, Al Darassa, Cairo, Egypt (P.O. Box 11675)	+20 2 25970400 (within Egypt: 107)	ask@dar-alifta.org	Website	Source	Appointed Grand Mufti of Egypt in 2024, succeeding Shawki Allam; in office September 2026 (official Dar al-Ifta statements, July 2026).
Sunni	Sheikh Saleh bin Fawzan Al-Fawzan	Grand Mufti of Saudi Arabia	Sheikh					Website	Source	Appointed 22 October 2025 by royal decree of King Salman, succeeding Abdulaziz bin Abdullah Al al-Sheikh, who died 23 September 2025 after 25 years in office; the first Grand Mufti not from the Al al-Sheikh family. Variant spellings: Salih al-Fawzan, Saleh bin Fawzan al-Fawzan. Official office contact details not published; listed site is the scholar's official site.
Sunni (Hanafi tradition)	Safi Arpagu■	President of the Presidency of Religious Affairs (Diyanet)	Prof. Dr.	Hatice Kelpetin Arpagu■	Üniversiteler Mah. Dumlup■nar Blv. No: 147/A, 06800 Çankaya, Ankara, Türkiye	+90 312 295 70 00		Website	Source	Appointed 18 September 2025 by presidential decree, succeeding Ali Erba■ (in office 2017-2025); in office September 2026 (2026 Ramadan theme and Hajj programs issued under his name).
Sunni	Muhammad Ahmad Hussein	Grand Mufti of Jerusalem and the Palestinian Territories	Sheikh		Jerusalem				Source	Appointed by Palestinian President Mahmoud Abbas in 2006; still in office as of September 2026 (fatwa announcements, Jan 2026; detention in July 2026 condemned by Turkish foreign ministry). Office publishes no contact details; no verified official website found.
Sunni	Sheikh Dr. Mohammed bin Abdulkarim Al-Issa	Secretary-General of the Muslim World League	His Excellency		Muslim World League, Old Jeddah Road, Makkah, Al Aqaba District, SA 24312, Saudi Arabia			Website	Source	In office since 2016; current as of September 2026 (MWL activities, August-September 2026). Religious-diplomatic office; the Muslim World League is an international Islamic NGO.
Sunni	Sheikh Dr. Abdulrahman Al-Sudais	President of Religious Affairs at the Grand Mosque and the Prophet's Mosque	Sheikh						Source	President of the Two Holy Mosques affairs since 2012 (re-appointed 2016 and 2020); after the 2023 restructuring he heads the Presidency of Religious Affairs of the Grand Mosque and the Prophet's Mosque; current as of 2026 (Ramadan 1447/2026 operational plan; SPA, July 2026). Office contact details not published; no verified official portal found.
Twelver Shi'ism	Mojtaba Khamenei	Supreme Leader of the Islamic Republic of Iran (Velayat-e Faqih)	Ayatollah					Website	Source	Succeeded his father Ali Khamenei, killed in a US-Israeli airstrike on 28 February 2026; selected by the Assembly of Experts on 8 March 2026 under wartime conditions, with the IRGC reported by Reuters as having driven the choice; simultaneously elevated from Hojjatoleslam to Ayatollah without official explanation. The succession, and the son-succeeds-father optics, were reported as politically and clerically contested; recorded here only as the holder of the religious office as of September 2026.
Twelver Shi'ism	Ali al-Husseini al-Sistani	Grand Ayatollah; Dean of the Hawza of Najaf	His Eminence		Najaf, Iraq			Website	Source	Senior living marja'; marja'iyyah since 1993; office active in 2026 (announcements, January and April 2026). Reports note no public appearance since October 2025; the office continues to function.
Twelver Shi'ism	Bashir al-Najafi	Grand Ayatollah (Marja' al-Taqlid)	Grand Ayatollah		Najaf, Iraq			Website	Source	Senior marja' of Najaf (b. 1942); active September 2026 (meetings reported August-September 2026).
Twelver Shi'ism	Hossein Vahid Khorasani	Grand Ayatollah; Head of the Qom Seminary (Hawza Ilmiyya)	Grand Ayatollah		Qom, Iran			Website	Source	Senior Qom marja' (b. 1921); regarded by some scholars as the most learned living Shia authority; current 2026.
Twelver Shi'ism	Naser Makarem Shirazi	Grand Ayatollah (Marja' al-Taqlid)	Grand Ayatollah		Qom, Iran			Website	Source	Senior Qom marja' (b. 1927); active 2026 (Hajj statement, July 2026).
Twelver Shi'ism	Hossein Nouri Hamedani	Grand Ayatollah (Marja' al-Taqlid)	Grand Ayatollah		Qom, Iran			Website	Source	Senior Qom marja' (b. 1925); active 2026 (memorial ceremonies, July 2026).
Nizari Ismaili Shi'ism	Prince Rahim Aga Khan V	Aga Khan V; 50th hereditary Imam of the Shia Ismaili Muslims	His Highness		Ismaili Imamat, Lisbon, Portugal			Website	Source	Succeeded his father Prince Karim Aga Khan IV (died 4 February 2025) by nass (designation) in his father's will; announced 5 February 2025 at the Ismaili Centre, Lisbon; succession uncontested. Divorced from Princess Salwa (formerly Kendra Spears); two sons.
Dawoodi Bohra (Tayyibi Ismaili Shi'ism)	Syedna Mufaddal Saifuddin	53rd al-Dai al-Mutlaq of the Dawoodi Bohra community	His Holiness					Website	Source	In office since 2014 (appointed by his father Mohammed Burhanuddin II); succession was challenged in court by Taher Fakhruddin; the Bombay High Court dismissed the challenge in April 2024, confirming him as Dai al-Mutlaq. Current as of 2026.
Ahmadiyya	Mirza Masroor Ahmad	Khalifatul Masih V (Fifth Caliph of the Messiah)	His Holiness	Sahibzadi Amatul Sabooh Begum	Mubarak Mosque, Islamabad, Tilford, Surrey, United Kingdom			Website	Source	Elected 22 April 2003; supreme head of the worldwide Ahmadiyya Muslim Community; current as of 2026 (weekly sermons, September 2026). Mainstream Islam does not recognize the Ahmadiyya movement as Muslim; it is included here as a distinct religious leadership office.

Hinduism

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Sringeri Sharada Peetham (Dakshinamnaya)	Sri Sri Bharati Tirtha Mahasannidhanam	Jagadguru Shankaracharya, 36th Peethadheeshwara of Sringeri Sharada Peetham	Sri Sri					Website	Source	First of the four cardinal peethams. The official site identifies him as the 36th Peethadheeshwara; successor-designate is Sri Sri Vidhushekhara Bharati Swamiji. Both observed Chaturmasya 29 July-26 September 2026, confirming current tenure. Celibate monastic office. Hinduism has no single head; each Shankaracharya leads only his own peetham.
Govardhana Math, Puri (Purvamnaya)	Nischalananda Saraswati	Shankaracharya of Govardhana Math, Puri						Website	Source	Full styling on the matha's official page: 'Swami Sri Nischalananda Saraswati-ji Maharaj'. The official biography states he was appointed head on 9 February 1992; a July 2026 report confirms him in office. Celibate monastic office.
Dwarka Sharada Peetham (Paschimamnaya)	Sadanand Saraswati	Shankaracharya of Dwarka Sharada Peetham							Source	Succeeded Swami Swaroopanand Saraswati (d. 11 September 2022); anointed at Paramhansi Ganga Ashram, Narsinghpur, September 2022 per PTI; active and issuing statements as Shankaracharya through 2026. Name also rendered 'Sadananda Saraswati'. Celibate monastic office. Official website left blank: the peetham's previously listed site could not be verified and directory listings conflict.
Jyotirmath (Uttaramnaya)	Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati	Claimant to Shankaracharya of Jyotirmath - succession disputed							Source	Declared successor by followers after Swami Swaroopanand Saraswati's death (11 September 2022) per PTI, September 2022. Rival claim by Swami Vasudevanand Saraswati. The Supreme Court's order of 14 October 2022 restrained any coronation pending Civil Appeals 3010/2020 and 3011/2020; the Prayagraj administration issued notices in 2025-26 questioning his claim. Listed here as a disputed claimant, not an undisputed incumbent. Celibate monastic office.
BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha	Mahant Swami Maharaj	Present Spiritual Guru, BAPS Swaminarayan Sanstha	His Holiness					Website	Source	Sixth and present spiritual guru in the BAPS guru parampara (monastic name Swami Keshavjivandasji), per BAPS official materials. Celibate monastic office.
Ramakrishna Math and Ramakrishna Mission	Swami Gautamananda	President, Ramakrishna Math and Ramakrishna Mission (17th President)	Most Revered					Website	Source	Full styling: 'Srimat Swami Gautamanandaji Maharaj'. Elected 17th President on 24 April 2024 per Belur Math; presiding at official events through July 2026. Celibate monastic office.
Chinmaya Mission	Swami Swaroopananda	Global Head, Chinmaya Mission	Pujya					Website	Source	Global Head since January 2017; identified as such in an official Chinmaya Mission report of 19 March 2026. Celibate monastic office.

Buddhism

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Tibetan Buddhism (Gelug; Dalai Lama institution)	Tenzin Gyatso	14th Dalai Lama	His Holiness					Website	Source	Spiritual leader of Tibetan Buddhism, in exile at Dharamshala, India. The official site listed him as scheduled for and attending a Long Life Offering Ceremony in Leh on 30 August 2026, confirming current status. Celibate monastic office.
Karma Kagyu (claimant A)	Ogyen Trinley Dorje	17th Gyalwa Karmapa - claimant (recognition disputed)	His Holiness					Website	Source	Recognized by Tai Situ Rinpoche and Goshir Gyaltsab Rinpoche, confirmed by the 14th Dalai Lama (official letter, 30 June 1992), enthroned at Tsurphu Monastery 27 September 1992. Rival claimant: Trinley Thaye Dorje (recognized by Shamar Rinpoche, enthroned 17 March 1994). Both claimants signed a joint statement acknowledging past divisions and pledging joint work to preserve the Karma Kagyu lineage. Celibate monastic office.
Karma Kagyu (claimant B)	Trinley Thaye Dorje	17th Gyalwa Karmapa - claimant (recognition disputed)	His Holiness	Rinchen Yangzom				Website	Source	Recognized by Shamar Rinpoche; enthroned 17 March 1994; named legal and administrative successor of the 16th Karmapa by the Karmapa Charitable Trust (17 May 2006); headquarters at Kalimpong, India. Married Rinchen Yangzom (announced 29 March 2017); he no longer performs ordinations. Co-signatory with Ogyen Trinley Dorje of the joint statement on preserving the Karma Kagyu lineage.
Thai Sangha (Theravada)	Somdet Phra Ariyavongsagatanana (Amborn Ambaro)	20th Supreme Patriarch of Thailand (Sangharaja)	His Holiness						Source	Appointed by King Vajiralongkorn; in office since February 2017; the term is for life. Heads both Thai Theravada fraternities (Maha Nikaya and Dhammayuttika Nikaya) and presides over the Sangha Supreme Council; also abbot of Wat Ratchabophit, Bangkok. The Sangha Supreme Council acknowledged preparations for his 99th birthday in 2026, confirming current tenure. Celibate monastic office.
Siyam Nikaya, Malwatta Chapter (Sri Lanka)	Thibbatuwawe Sri Siddhartha Sumangala Thera	Mahanayake Thera (Chief Prelate), Malwatta Chapter of the Siyam Nikaya	Most Ven.						Source	26th Mahanayake Thera of the Malwatta Chapter; elevated 20 June 2004 by the Karaka Sanga Sabha; based at Malwatta Maha Viharaya, Kandy. A Sri Lankan government programme of 16 April 2026 refers to the incumbent chief prelates of the two chapters. Celibate monastic office.
Siyam Nikaya, Asgiriya Chapter (Sri Lanka)	Warakagoda Sri Gnanarathana Thera	Mahanayaka Thera (Chief Prelate), Asgiriya Chapter of the Siyam Nikaya	Most Ven.						Source	22nd Mahanayake Thera of the Asgiriya Chapter since 7 April 2016; also Chancellor of the Buddhist and Pali University of Sri Lanka. Identified as the incumbent chief prelate in 2026 reporting. Celibate monastic office.
Myanmar Sangha (State Sangha Maha Nayaka Committee)	Bhaddanta Candima Bhivamsa	Chairman, State Sangha Maha Nayaka Committee (Thanlyin Min Kyaung Sayadaw)							Source	Thanlyin Min Kyaung Sayadaw. Identified as chairman of the State Sangha Maha Nayaka Committee in state media reports of February and July 2026. Celibate monastic office.
Sakya school of Tibetan Buddhism	Gyana Vajra Rinpoche	43rd Sakya Trizin (holder of the Sakya throne)	His Holiness	Dagmo Sonam Palkyi				Website	Source	The throne passed from his elder brother Ratna Vajra (42nd Sakya Trizin) to him on 16 March 2022; he resides at the Sakya Dolma Phodrang, Rajpur, India. The Sakya throne is hereditary in the Khon family and the Trizin may marry: he married Her Eminence Dagmo Sonam Palkyi (also called Dagmo Kushok) on 24 February 2008, per the office's official site.
Gelug school of Tibetan Buddhism	Jetsun Lobsang Dorjee Pelsangpo	105th Ganden Tripa, spiritual head of the Gelug school	His Holiness						Source	Formerly Sharpa Choeje Rinpoche; given the responsibility of 105th Ganden Tripa by the 14th Dalai Lama on 2 November 2024 and enthroned at Gaden Lachi on 26 November 2024. The Ganden Tripa is an appointed, seven-year, merit-based office (not a tulku lineage). Celibate monastic office. The 104th Ganden Tripa, Lobsang Tenzin Pelsangpo, died 26 September 2025.

Sikhism

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Akal Takht (SGPC)	Giani Kuldeep Singh Gargaj	Acting Jathedar of the Akal Takht; Jathedar of Takht Sri Kesgarh Sahib							Source	Appointed by the SGPC on 7 March 2025 after the removal of Giani Raghbir Singh; assumed charge 10 March 2025; as acting Jathedar he released the Nanakshahi calendar for Sammat 558 (2026-27). Surname also rendered 'Gadgaj'/'Garhgaj'. A rival line named by the 2015 Sarbat Khalsa (Jagtar Singh Hawara / acting Dhian Singh Mand) is not recognized by the SGPC.

Jainism

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Shwetambar Terapanth	Acharya Mahashraman	Acharya, head of the Shwetambar Terapanth						Website	Source	Styled 'Acharyashri Mahashraman' on the order's official site, which identifies him as the current head of the Shwetambar Terapanth organization; active through September 2026. Celibate monastic office.
Digambara (Vidyasagar sangh)	Acharya Samaysagar (Niryapak Muni Samaysagar Ji Maharaj)	Acharya, head of the Digambara Vidyasagar sangh						Website	Source	Designated successor of Acharya Vidyasagar (d. 18 February 2024) on 6 February 2024, with formal investiture reported as scheduled for 16 April 2024 at Kundalpur before an assembly of about 400 munis and aryikas. Digambara Jainism has no single universal head; this row covers the Vidyasagar sangh, the largest Digambara order. Celibate monastic office.

Shinto

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Jinja Honcho (Association of Shinto Shrines)	Tsunekiyo Tanaka	Soch■ (President / Secretary-General), Jinja Honcho	Revd					Website	Source	Chief executive and representative officer of the association of about 80,000 shrines. Above the Soch■ stand the largely ceremonial Sosai (the head priestess of Ise Grand Shrine) and the T■ri (Takatsukasa Naotake, since 2018). Tanaka's tenure was disputed 2022-2024 after the T■ri nominated a rival, Ashihara Takao; Tanaka's fifth term was confirmed by the T■ri's nomination on 12 December 2024.

Taoism

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Chinese Taoist Association	Li Guangfu	President (■■), Chinese Taoist Association	Ven.		■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■9■■■■			Website	Source	Also known as Li Chengdao (■■■). President since June 2015; re-elected for the 11th council in December 2025. Also chairman of the World Federation of Taoism (founded September 2023). The Zhengyi Celestial Master (Tianshi) lineage is excluded: after the 64th Celestial Master Zhang Yuanxian died in 2008, multiple rival claimants to the 65th title exist in mainland China and Taiwan, with no universally recognized incumbent.

Judaism

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Orthodox	Rabbi Kalman Meir Ber	Ashkenazi Chief Rabbi of Israel; President of the Chief Rabbinate Council	Rabbi	Dafna Ber (née Elitzur)	5 Aholiav St., Jerusalem, P.O.B 36016, 9446778, Israel	02-5313191	rabbia@rab.gov.il		Source	Elected in the 2024 Chief Rabbinate elections (first round 29 Sept 2024, second round 31 Oct 2024); took office 4 November 2024 for a 10-year term. Office address, phone and email quoted character-for-character from the Chief Rabbinate's official letterhead (2 July 2026). Official Hebrew honorific used by the office: ■■■■״■ (shlita). Cross-checked against the Chief Rabbinate election record. Judaism has no single world head; the Chief Rabbinate is Israel's state religious authority.
Orthodox	Rabbi David Yosef	Sephardi Chief Rabbi of Israel (Rishon LeZion); President of the Supreme Rabbinical Court	Rabbi	Sofia Yosef	5 Aholiav St., Jerusalem, P.O.B 36016, 9446778, Israel	02-5313191	rabbia@rab.gov.il		Source	Elected 29 September 2024; took office 4 November 2024 for a 10-year term (Rishon LeZion, 43rd holder of the title). Office address, phone and email quoted from the Chief Rabbinate's official letterhead (2 July 2026). Official Hebrew honorific: ■■■■״■ (shlita). Cross-checked against the Chief Rabbinate election record. Judaism has no single world head.
Orthodox	Chief Rabbi Sir Ephraim Mirvis KBE	Chief Rabbi of the United Hebrew Congregations of the Commonwealth	Chief Rabbi	Valerie Mirvis	Office of the Chief Rabbi, 305 Ballards Lane, London, N12 8GB, UK	+44 (0)20 8343 6301	info@chiefrabbi.org	Website	Source	Installed 1 September 2013; 11th Chief Rabbi of the United Hebrew Congregations of the Commonwealth. Knighted 2023 (KBE). Office address, phone and email from the official site's contact page (crawled Sept 2026). Spouse Valerie Mirvis per the official biography.
Orthodox	Rabbi Haïm Korsia	Chief Rabbi of France (Grand Rabbin de France)	Grand Rabbin						Source	Elected 22 June 2014 by the Central Consistory of France (Consistoire central israélite de France); re-elected 6 June 2021 for a seven-year term (through 2028). Confirmed in office by Le Monde, May 2026. Included as one other major national chief rabbi with a clear, verifiable office. Official consistoire website not captured verbatim in sources checked; no published office contact details found.

Zoroastrianism

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Parsi (Shehenshahi)	Vada Dasturji Khurshed K. Dastoor	Vada Dasturji (High Priest) of the Iranshah Atash Behram, Udvada	Dasturji						Source	One of two serving high priests of the Iranshah Atash Behram at Udvada, Gujarat — the most sacred Parsi fire temple, housing the sacred fire brought from Sanjan. Zoroastrianism has NO single world head; the Udvada high-priestly office is the most senior priestly office of the Indian Parsi community but is not a world head. Confirmed as Udvada High Priest in a 2026 community petition; also documented as high priest of Udvada in 2018 press coverage. No published office contact details found.
Parsi (Shehenshahi)	Vada Dasturji Tehemton B. Mirza	Vada Dasturji (High Priest) of the Iranshah Atash Behram, Udvada	Dasturji						Source	One of two serving high priests of the Iranshah Atash Behram at Udvada, Gujarat. Zoroastrianism has NO single world head; included only as the highest-profile high-priestly office, which is shared between two concurrent Vada Dasturjis (Dastoor and Mirza). Named as Udvada High Priest in a 2026 community petition. No published office contact details found.

Yazidism

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
	Mir Hazim Tahsin Beg	Mir of the Yazidis; head of the Supreme Yazidi Spiritual Council	His Excellency						Source	Hereditary Mir since 2019 (succeeded Mir Tahsin Beg, d. 2019). The Mir presides over the Supreme Yazidi Spiritual Council (headquartered at Lalish) and is the highest political and religious authority of the Yazidi community worldwide; the Mir appoints the Baba Sheikh. Address form 'His Excellency / Your Excellency' used by the Presidency of the Kurdistan Region of Iraq (Aug 2025). No official published office address, phone or email found.
	Sheikh Ali Ilyas	Baba Sheikh (Extiyarê Mergehê) — head of the Yazidi clergy	His Excellency						Source	Appointed Baba Sheikh in November 2020 (confirmed in a statement by KRG Prime Minister Masrour Barzani); succeeded the late Baba Sheikh Khurto Hajji Ismail (d. October 2020) — the succession around 2020 is thus confirmed. Variant spellings in official sources: Ali Elias / Ali Sheikh Alyas. Cross-checked as current in 2026 coverage. No official published office address, phone or email found.

Druze

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
	Sheikh Sami Abilmona	Sheikh al-Aql of the Druze Community in Lebanon	Sheikh						Source	Elected in 2021 as Sheikh al-Aql (Sheikh Akl) of the Lebanese Druze community; received as Sheikh Akl by Lebanese Parliament Speaker Nabih Berri (Lebanese official news agency NNA, 2026). The Druze have NO single world head — Lebanon, Israel and Syria each have their own senior religious leadership. No published office contact details found.
	Sheikh Muwaffaq Tarif	Spiritual Leader of the Druze Community in Israel	Sheikh						Source	Spiritual leader of Israel's Druze since 1993 (succeeded his grandfather Amin Tarif). Active in office as of January 2026 (led delegation visiting Syrian Druze patients at Rambam). The Druze have NO single world head. No published office contact details found.
	Sheikh Hikmat al-Hijri	Sheikh al-Aql of the Druze of Suwayda, Syria	Sheikh						Source	One of three Sheikh al-Aql in Syria and the most politically prominent as of September 2026. Caveat: Syrian Druze religious leadership is fragmented and contested amid the ongoing conflict; included with this factual caveat. The Druze have NO single world head. No published office contact details found.

Tenrikyo

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
Japanese new religion	Nakayama Zenji	Shinbashira of Tenrikyo		Harue Nakayama				Website	Source	Fourth Shinbashira, in office since 1998. Per the Constitution of Tenrikyo the Shinbashira is the administrative and spiritual leader who governs Tenrikyo (Tenrikyo Church Headquarters, Tenri, Nara, Japan). Tenrikyo's own English publications use no personal honorific - the office is styled 'the Shinbashira'; salutation left blank on that basis. Spouse Harue Nakayama per official Tenrikyo Online. Currency confirmed via the official Tenrikyo Online New Year's address.

Bahá'í

Branch / Communion	Leader	Title	Salutation	Spouse	Office Address	Phone	Email	Website	Source	Notes
	The Universal House of Justice	Supreme governing council of the Bahá'í Faith (nine-member collective body)			Bahá'í World Centre, P.O. Box 155, 3100101 Haifa, Israel	+972 (4) 835 8358	secretariat@bwc.org	Website	Source	Collective body, not an individual: nine members elected every five years by the members of the world's National Spiritual Assemblies; seated at the Bahá'í World Centre on Mt. Carmel, Haifa. Individual members' names are not officially published on bahai.org — the body acts and signs only as a collective, so no names are listed here. Address, phone and email quoted from official Universal House of Justice correspondence (message of 1 December 2025).